

Schoenheit, Victoria M (GOV)

From: Chad Hutchison <clhutchison@alaska.edu>
Sent: Thursday, May 21, 2026 11:29 AM
To: Schoenheit, Victoria M (GOV); Michelle Rizk; Katie McCall
Subject: Re: For Victoria - CONFIDENTIAL - ATTORNEY MEMORANDUM ATTACHED - From UA - Recommended Vetoes on Rep. Carrick's HB10 and HB176

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Victoria,

One more thing for your consideration:

Our fees are already completely listed out...to both our students and to every member of the public: <https://www.uaf.edu/finserv/uaf-tuition-committee/consolidated-fee.php>

What does the UAF Consolidated Fee support?

The table below outlines how the UAF Consolidated Fee is distributed among the 16 departments supported by this fee. These departments provide a variety of services, programs, and resources that support students across the university.

Additional descriptions of the services provided by each department are listed below the table.

Department / Program	Distribution (%)
Health & Counseling	18.5%
Center for Teaching & Learning	12.0%
Athletics	11.5%
Nanook Recreation	11.5%
CSE Transformative Experiences	10.0%
Library	9.5%
Nanook Technology Services	6.5%
Student Success Center / Tutoring	5.0%
Transportation	4.0%
Student Media	2.5%

Department / Program	Distribution (%)
ASUAF	2.0%
Sustainability	2.0%
Graduate School	2.0%
CTC Technology Support & Refresh	2.0%
General Studies / URSA Support	0.5%
Student Arts & Production Access	0.5%

Descriptions for what services the consolidated fee supports by distribution includes:

How is my consolidated fee distributed?

The UAF Consolidated Fee is assessed at \$56 per credit hour. For example, a student enrolled in 12 credit hours during a semester would pay \$672 in consolidated fees.

The revenue collected through the consolidated fee is automatically distributed to the departments supported by the fee according to a predetermined percentage allocation.

The table below provides an example of how the \$672 consolidated fee for a student taking 12 credit hours would be distributed across the departments supported by this fee.

Department / Program	Distribution %	Amount from \$672 (12 credits)
Health & Counseling	18.5%	\$124.32
Center for Teaching & Learning	12.0%	\$80.64
Athletics	11.5%	\$77.28
Nanook Recreation	11.5%	\$77.28
CSE Transformative Experiences	10.0%	\$67.20
Library	9.5%	\$63.84
Nanook Technology Services	6.5%	\$43.68
Student Success Center / Tutoring	5.0%	\$33.60
Transportation	4.0%	\$26.88

Department / Program	Distribution %	Amount from \$672 (12 credits)
Student Media	2.5%	\$16.80
ASUAF	2.0%	\$13.44
Sustainability	2.0%	\$13.44
Graduate School	2.0%	\$13.44
CTC Technology Support & Refresh	2.0%	\$13.44
General Studies / URSA Support	0.5%	\$3.36
Student Arts & Production Access	0.5%	\$3.36
Total	100.0%	\$672.00

Who decides the fee and distribution amounts?

The UAF Tuition Committee is responsible for conducting an annual review of the consolidated fee and its distribution to supported departments. These reviews are published on the committee's [Consolidated Fee Reviews](#) webpage.

Decisions regarding changes to the fee amount or distribution percentages are made by UAF's Core Cabinet. When potential changes are being considered, Core Cabinet may request that the Tuition Committee review and evaluate proposed adjustments.

Any approved changes to the consolidated fee or its distribution are finalized the spring before the academic year of implementation. This timeline ensures that updated fee information is available for inclusion in the UAF course catalog, allowing students time to review the changes and plan for the upcoming academic year.

Chad Hutchison

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On Thu, May 21, 2026 at 11:19 AM Chad Hutchison <clhutchison@alaska.edu> wrote:
Victoria,

Following up on our discussion a few moments ago, please see below. I also sent this to Jordan. Happy to discuss with either of you.

Pursuant to the direction of President Pat Pitney, who is in agreement with Board of Regents Chair Scott Jepsen, I provide you with the following narrative to support the UA's recommendation to veto Rep. Carrick's HB 10 (the faculty regent bill) and Rep. Carrick's HB176 (the "transparency feel bill"). President Pitney and Chair Jepsen are cc'd here.

HB10

- [House Bill 10](#) (HB10) adds a faculty member to the Board of Regents. UA recommends a veto of this legislation.
- Conflicts of Interest and Structural Issues – No regent is an employee under the current Board structure. A faculty member is a university employee. Employees serving as regents would have broad and pervasive personal, financial, and structural conflicts of interest.
 - The Board has a fiduciary duty to act in the best interests of the university and the public. Sometimes, this duty requires the Board to make difficult decisions that may be adverse to employee (including faculty) interests. The expectation that a faculty regent will represent faculty interests and perspectives is in direct conflict with the fiduciary duties of a regent.
 - The administration, and ultimately the President, supervise faculty. The Board supervises the President and hold her accountable for the administration. A faculty regent is placed in the untenable position of having authority over the person ultimately responsible for supervision of university employees.
 - Faculty are represented by a union and the terms and conditions of faculty employment are determined through collective bargaining. The Board approves the collective bargaining agreement. Adding a faculty regent would place faculty on three sides of the decision-making table: on the Board as "management," in collective bargaining, and in faculty governance.
 - Due to these conflicts, the law (including the Executive Branch Ethics Act) will require the Board to exclude faculty regents from discussion and action on decisions affecting faculty, which are the very issues on which their constituents would want them involved.
 - Adding a faculty regent creates a structural governance issue. Adding a faculty regent will bring the total number of voting regents to twelve. A board consisting of an even number can result in tied votes, which results in inaction through failed votes. Adding one more regent means that it will take seven votes to make difficult decisions.
 - The proposed legislation establishing a faculty regent essentially created a special interest regent. Faculty interests may diverge from the public interest and politicizes university governance.

- Employee Participation in University Governance Is Robust Without Employee Regents – The Board has created and supports a robust structure to provide for faculty and staff input in University decision-making.
 - Active governance groups are as follows:
 - System wide Governance Groups include:
 - Faculty Alliance
 - Staff Alliance
 - Coalition of Student Leaders
 - System Governance Council
 - System Office Staff Council
 - Individual University-Based Governance Groups include:
 - UAF, UAA & UAS Faculty Senates
 - UAF, UAA, UAS & SW Staff Governance Groups
 - See <http://www.alaska.edu/governance/>

HB176

- Rep. Carrick's bill, [HB176](#), simply “adds to the statute books,” and “sounds good,” but has no added benefit or value to the UA or its students/faculty/staff. UA recommends a veto to this legislation.
- One Senator in support of the bill doesn't appear to know what's actually on UAF's campus, or that consolidated fees (which are public facing and readily open to everyone) don't “hide” anything. Please see for yourself: <https://www.uaf.edu/finserv/uaf-tuition-committee/consolidated-fee.php> - Please contact Chad Hutchison, who is actually on campus everyday at UAF during the interim to get the truth about what is and is not on campus.
- HB176 hampers the UA from being responsive to current and future student leaders.
- Rep. Carrick should not be trying to micro-manage the University based on popular “buzz words” and flawed/outdated memories about how student fees work.
- Current UA Regent Policy already covers this issue. [UA Regents' Policy and Regulation](#) stipulate how fees are created and managed. The Board does not typically impose new fees, as this authority rests with the UA President and by delegation with Chancellors, per this Policy:
 - P05.10.070. Student Fees.
 - Student fees, including student government fees, shall be established and approved by the president. The president may delegate this authority and responsibility to the chancellors or the chancellor's designees
- The language of the bill may lead to confusion, as it incorrectly presumes that the Board of Regents on an operational level instead of one that implements broad policy.
- Rep. Carrick's legislative process was very flawed. One House Education Committee referral (UA did not get an initial invite to testify on bill that affected the University), with no second House committee referral (an error that was not corrected in the House for unknown reasons); a Senate Education Committee where the UA did not have the chance to testify, despite earlier assurances; and at Senate State Affairs where the UA was not invited to testify despite being on the phone to answer questions.
- Noteworthy: This bill will appear to have a lot of legislative support. It is unknown how many understand it or have given it a thorough review. It's unclear, based on public testimony, that the primary supporters (Rep. Carrick and Sen. Myers) are even aligned with what the bill actually does.
- This bill sets minimum notice requirements (30 days) for any changes to student fees—however, the university already has a much higher standard than this. Current practice

typically gives students a minimum of at least **three months** notice for any proposed fee changes. In other instances, students have been given notice almost a **year** in advance when system-wide fees are set to increase.

- Noteworthy: The UA process for creating/adjusting the fees intended in this bill involve months of work with the elected student representatives at the university where the action is being considered. This includes, for example, USUAA holding public hearings where administrative departments present details regarding existing fees and any proposed changes. They then pass resolutions regarding the proposals that weigh heavily on the administration regarding the final decision.
- In private meetings with the university, the bill sponsors have stated that current university policy/practice surrounding student fees is acceptable and does not need to be altered, though they still feel it's necessary to codify standards that the university already exceeds. Their position continues to leave UA administration confused as to why this bill would be necessary if they have no objection to existing practice.
- In committee hearings, testimony from the bill sponsors targeted the "consolidated fee" as an issue and alluded to their desire to dismantle the consolidated fee, returning to prior practice of charging students dozens of individual fees for services that benefit students at each university. However, the consolidated fee was implemented to simplify the student bill after years of complaints *from students* that their bill was far too long and confusing to easily understand. The consolidated fee is also designed to simplify students' ability to quickly calculate the cost of attendance without having to add up dozens of individual fees. The criticism that the consolidated fee lacks transparency is entirely unfounded, as each university website contains detailed breakdowns of exactly how revenue from the consolidated fee is distributed toward various student services. Not only is this information available to current students, it's publicly available for anyone to see.
 - Noteworthy: The erroneous testimony from bill sponsors largely focused on outdated procedures from UAF. This created the false assumption that this was a "system-wide" issue when it is not.

Further, this bill would make **zero changes** to the consolidated fee. If the bill sponsors' intent is to abolish the consolidated fee, then the passage of this bill would do nothing to accomplish that goal, because nothing in the legislation would eliminate the consolidated fee. Again, this bill would not do anything **at all** to alter current university policy regarding student fees. This legislation would add more language to our statute books, yet would have absolutely no effect on students or university operations.

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